## Course Information:

Fall 2025: ECE 29401-001 Sophomore Seminar (CRN: 20774) 1 credit

In-Person Instruction

## Instructor Information:

Jamie Seadeek

Office Hours:

Mondays 10:00 – 11:00am

*If this time doesn't work with your schedule, email me for an apt.

Please put ECE 29401 in the subject line

## Required Text

REQUIRED TEXTBOOK:

Working Smarter, Not Just Harder by Dr. Karl W. Reid, Ed.D., 2017, ISBN: 0692834907

## Course Description

This course is an introduction to the Elmore Family School of Electrical and Computer Engineering, the ECE program objectives and outcomes, BSEE & BSCmpE degree requirements, what it means to be an ethical student and engineer, and professional development opportunities.

## Meeting Times/Attendance

Attendance is required for this course so you are expected to attend all sessions. Attendance is based on arrival and departure time as well as participation in the group discussion at the end of each session. If you arrive to class more than 10 minutes late or leave more than 10 minutes early, you will not receive points for the day. Each session is worth 100 points and partial points will not be given. Should you miss a class, there are make-up assignments for certain weeks that can be completed to earn up to 50% of the attendance points; ***however, this still counts as an absence and three or more absences will result in failure of the course.*** Students are allowed two absences without jeopardizing successful completion of this course. When conflicts or absences can be anticipated, such as for any University-sponsored activities and religious observations, you should inform the instructor of the situation as far in advance as possible.

When you are unable to make direct contact with the instructor/unable to leave word with the instructor's department because of circumstances beyond your control, and in cases falling under excused absence regulations, you or your representative should contact or go to the Office of the Dean of Students website to complete appropriate forms for instructor notification. Under academic regulations, excused absences may be granted for cases of grief/bereavement, military service, jury duty, parenting leave, or certain medically excused absences. For details, see the Classes section of the University Regulations website.

## Student Learning Outcomes

A student who successfully fulfills the course requirements for ECE 29401 will have demonstrated:

- a knowledge of the BSEE and BSCmpE degree requirements
- an ability to prepare a satisfactory personal plan of study
- an ability to write effectively in the English language
- an appreciation for ethical professional and academic conduct.

## Grading

This class will be graded on the basis of attendance, group participation and assignments. A student is allowed up to two absences and still pass the class. There are a few sessions with a make-up assignment where students can get up to half of the attendance points; however, it does not erase that absence. Any make-up assignment completed must be completed and turned in via Brightspace no later than 11:59 p.m. the day before the next class session.

**A failing grade for the course will be given to any student suspected of falsifying attendance for themselves or a group member, or using AI to complete any part of their essay. In addition, there are three ways to automatically fail this course: 1) miss three or more sessions regardless of completing make-up assignments, or 2) *failure to turn in your essay and receive a passing grade, or 3) failure to pass the final quiz with a grade of C or higher.***

## Assignments

All assignments must be uploaded in Brightspace by 11:59 pm EST on the date that they are due. All essays will follow MLA formatting. ***Late assignments will be deducted 10% per week until the assignment is turned into Brightspace.***

| GRADE | |
|---|---|
| 1800 – 2000 | A |
| 1600 – 1799 | B |
| 1400 – 1599 | C |
| 1200 – 1399 | D |
| ≤ 1199 | F |

| Assignments | Due | Points |
|---|---|---|
| Attendance/participation | Throughout the semester | 1500 |
| Scavenger Hunt | September 2nd | 60 |
| Resume (final copy) | September 8th | 60 |
| Engineering Essay | September 23rd | 60 |
| Degree Checklist | October 27th | 60 |
| Quizzes | Throughout the semester | 60 |
| TaskHuman Meeting | Throughout the semester | 100 |
| Final Quiz | December 12th | 100 |
| | | |
| | | Total: 2000 |

## Make-Up Assignments

Some weeks have ways to make up half the points missed for that session. This does not take away the absence, it just allows you to recoup some points and still do something meaningful for that topic. The weekly schedule will tell you which category to use for the make-up assignment.

## Group Participation

Group work is a common thread throughout your time in ECE and at Purdue, and success in your program will depend on you building these connections. To start this off, you will be placed in teams of 6 members, with whom you will sit with in class to complete discussions throughout the semester. You must participate fully in person for each discussion to receive points. Students are expected to be respectful to their team members and each team member will take a turn at being the discussion leader and submitting the discussion post that includes the team number and full name of each member **who were on time and participated in the discussion**.

## Classroom Guidance Regarding Protect Purdue

Any student who has substantial reason to believe that another person is threatening the safety of others by not complying with Protect Purdue protocols is encouraged to report the behavior to and discuss the next steps with their instructor. Students also have the option of reporting the behavior to the Office of the Student Rights and Responsibilities. See also Purdue University Bill of Student Rights and the Violent Behavior Policy under University Resources in Brightspace.

### *Purdue Honor Pledge*

"As a Boilermaker pursuing academic excellence, I pledge to be honest and true in all that I do. Accountable together - we are Purdue.

## Students with Disabilities

"Purdue University strives to make learning experiences as accessible as possible. If you anticipate or experience physical or academic barriers based on disability, you are welcome to let me know so that we can discuss options. You are also encouraged to contact the Disability Resource Center at: **drc@purdue.edu** or by phone: 765-494-1247." More details are available on our course Brightspace under Accessibility Information.

## Academic Integrity and Professional Honesty

*Under the Brightspace University Policies and Statements content is a hyperlink called "Purdue's Student Guide for Academic Integrity" that links to the Office of Student Rights and Responsibilities Academic Integrity webpage and a link named "Use of Copyrighted Materials" that links to a University Policy Office webpage. This course follows the Student Conduct relation that states "Students are expected to adhere to the guidelines provided by instructors for academic work so that no student gains an unfair advantage. Using or attempting to use unauthorized materials, information, study aids, notes, or any other device in any academic exercise will not be tolerated. Unauthorized materials may include anything which or anyone who gives a student assistance that has not been approved by the instructor in advance."*

For ECE 29401, examples of cheating include (but are not limited to) falsifying attendance, the use of AI for all assignments and specifically your required essay, and/or representing someone else's work as your own for class assignments and make-up assignments. In addition, all ECE students are expected to know and uphold the IEEE Code of Ethics to ensure you are a responsible engineer and representative of your field during all co-op and internship sessions, full-time employment and/or graduate school.

## Diversity and Inclusion

Purdue University is committed to maintaining a community which recognizes and values the inherent worth and dignity of every person; fosters tolerance, sensitivity, understanding, and mutual respect among its members; and encourages each individual to strive to reach his or her own potential. In pursuit of its goal of academic excellence, the University seeks to develop and nurture diversity. The University believes that diversity among its many members strengthens the institution, stimulates creativity, promotes the exchange of ideas, and enriches campus life. More details are available on our course Brightspace table of contents, under University Policies.

## Mental Health Statement

**If you find yourself beginning to feel some stress, anxiety and/or feeling slightly overwhelmed, try WellTrack**. Sign in and find information and tools at your fingertips, available to you at any time.

**If you need support and information about options and resources,** please contact or see the Office of the Dean of Students. Call 765-494-1747. Hours of operation are M-F, 8 am- 5 pm.

**If you find yourself struggling to find a healthy balance between academics, social life, stress, etc.** sign up for free one-on-one virtual or in-person sessions with a Purdue Wellness Coach at RecWell. Student coaches can help you navigate through barriers and challenges toward your goals throughout the semester. Sign up is completely free and can be done on BoilerConnect. If you have any questions, please contact Purdue Wellness at evans240@purdue.edu.

**If you're struggling and need mental health services:** Purdue University is committed to advancing the mental health and well-being of its students. If you or someone you know is feeling overwhelmed, depressed, and/or in need of mental health support, services are available. For help, such individuals should contact Counseling and Psychological Services (CAPS) at 765-494-6995 during and after hours, on weekends and holidays, or by going to the CAPS office of the second floor of the Purdue University Student Health Center (PUSH) during business hours.

## Basic Needs Security

Any student who faces challenges securing their food or housing and believes this may affect their performance in the course is urged to contact the Dean of Students for support. There is no appointment needed and Student Support Services is available to serve students 8 a.m.-5 p.m. Monday through Friday. Considering the significant disruptions caused by the current global crisis as it related to COVID-19, students may submit requests for emergency assistance from the Critical Needs Fund

## EMERGENCY POLICY

In the event of a major campus emergency, course requirements, deadlines and grading percentages are subject to changes that may be necessitated by a revised semester calendar or other circumstances beyond

the instructor's control. Relevant changes to this course will be posted onto the course website or can be obtained by contacting the instructor via email or phone. *You are expected to read your @purdue.edu email on a frequent basis.*

https://www.purdue.edu/ehps/emergency_preparedness/bep/REC-bep.html

## Protect Purdue Pledge

Being a part of the Boilermaker community means that each of us must take extraordinary steps to stay well and persistently protect each other, on campus and in the community. Accountable together, I pledge to take responsibility for my own health, the protection of others and help keep the Purdue community safe from spread of COVID-19 and other infections as identified and instructed by the university.

## Disclaimer

This syllabus is subject to change. You will be notified of changes as far in advance as possible via an announcement on Brightspace and an email, so please monitor these and get into the habit of checking them both prior to coming to class.

# Semester Schedule

| Date | Topic | In-Class Activity/ Discussion | Assignment | Due Date |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Week 1<br>8/26/2025 | Course Introduction and Task Human<br>(Milind Kulkarni, Rosa McDonald, Jamie Seadeek) | Introductions | Scavenger Hunt<br>Chapters 1 and 2 | 9/2/2025 |
| Week 2<br>9/2/2025 | Building Your Professional Resume<br>(Anna Swenson) | Peer Resume Review | Final Resume<br>Read Chapter 3 | 9/08/2025 |
| Week 3<br>9/9/2025 | Time Management<br>(Jamie Seadeek) | "Manage Your Monkeys" | None | None |
| Week 4<br>9/16/2025 | Degree Requirements<br>**BSEE – Regular Classroom**<br>**CMPE – GO TO WALC B058** | What's Your Plan Part I | AC and PES Video and Quiz | 9/22/2025 |
| Week 5<br>9/23/2025 | Automatic Control (Shreyas Sundaram); Power & Energy Systems (Vassilis Kekatos) | AC/PES Activity | Engineering Essay<br>FO and MN Video and Quiz | 09/29/2025 |
| Week 6<br>09/30/2025 | Fields & Optics (Luis Gomez); Microelectronics & Nanotechnology<br>(____) | MN/FO Activity | VLSI and CNS&IP Video and Quiz | 10/6/2025 |
| Week 7<br>10/07/2025 | Very Large Scale Integration (Anand Raghunathan); Communication, Network, Signal & Image Processing (Stanley Chan) | VLSI & CNS&IP Activity | TaskHuman Assignment for Groups 1-10 | 10/13/2025 |
| Week 8<br>10/15/2025 | Study Abroad (Cindy Quillen)<br>**THIS SESSION IS VIRTUAL FOR ALL SECTIONS AT 7PM ON 10/15/2025** | None | CE Video and Quiz | 10/20/2025 |
| Week 9<br>10/21/2025 | Computer Engineering: Hardware vs Software<br>(Steve France) | Computer Engineering Activity | Read Chapter 4<br>Degree Checklist | 10/27/2025 |

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|---|---|---|---|---|
| Week 10<br>10/28/2025 | Degree Checklist<br>(Instructor and ECE Advisors) | What's Your Plan Part II | TaskHuman Meeting for Groups 11-20 | 10/27/2025 |
| Week 11<br>11/4/2025 | 4+1<br>(Lynn Hegewald & Lacey Siefers) | | Read Chapter 5 | None |
| Week 12<br>11/11/2025 | Graduate School Experience<br>(ECE Graduate Students) | | Professional Ethics Presentations and Quiz | 11/17/2025 |
| Week 13<br>11/18/2025 | Professional and Academic Ethics<br>(Brent Jesiek) | | TaskHuman for Groups 21-30 | 12/01/2025 |
| **Week of November 24 - 28<br>Thanksgiving Break – No Class** | | | | |
| Week 14<br>12/2/2025 | EURO - Engineering Undergraduate Research Office<br>(Shruthika Sundar) | | Practice Quiz (for your use only – not graded) | 12/08/2025 |
| Week 15<br>12/09/2025 | In-Class quiz<br>**You must have your laptop to take the quiz** | | | 12/09/2025 |
| Week 15<br>12/11-12/2025 | Spark Challenge<br>Bill & Shirley Rice Design Studio<br>MSEE | | All students are **required to attend** the Spark Challenge. You pick the day and time that works best for you. The event runs 9:00am – 4pm and you must stay for a minimum of 50 minutes. You may attend on Thursday or Friday; whichever best fits your schedule. Keep in mind that judging could end early so plan accordingly and do not plan to arrive any later than 3:00pm or you will not get in the required amount of time. | |